Why Japanese brands love mascots



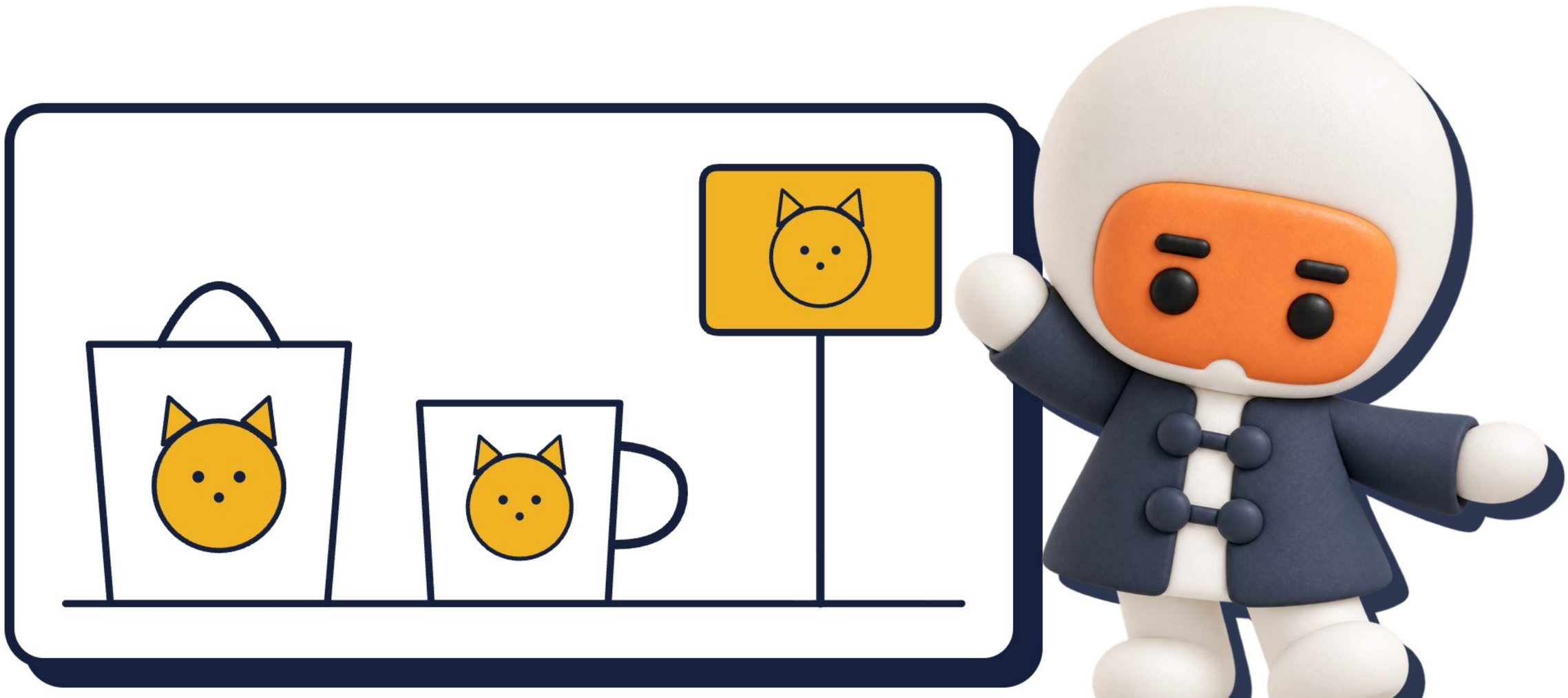
Aidan McFarlane

01

A mascot can say what a logo can’t

It can post, apologise, celebrate and explain without sounding corporate.

And it fits on everything.



What makes one work



Silhouette Simple enough to draw from memory

Personality Written down, not just drawn

Rules Clear terms for how others can use it

02

Kumamon's open licence

Kumamoto Prefecture lets businesses use the bear for free when the use promotes the region.

That openness put the character on products far beyond Kumamoto.

1. Apply to the prefecture
2. Use the character for free
3. Promote Kumamoto



In Japan, the mascot is often the brand's main voice.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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